Koeun Choi **October 2026**

CONTACT INFORMATION

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Human Development and Family Science
Virginia Tech
Blacksburg, Virginia 24061 USA

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EDUCATION

2016 **University of Wisconsin-Madison**, Wisconsin, USA
Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Studies;
Minor in Educational Psychology
Dissertation: *Toddlers' learning from touch screens: The role of working memory*

2011 **Seoul National University**, Seoul, South Korea
M.A. in Child Development and Family Studies
Thesis: *Two-, three-, and four-year-olds' use of accuracy cues in word learning*

2008 **Seoul National University**, Seoul, South Korea

B.A. in Child Development and Family Studies, *cum laude*;
Double Major in Psychology

PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

08/2025 - Present Department of Human Development and Family Science
Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University (Virginia Tech), Blacksburg, Virginia, USA
Associate Professor

08/2018 - 07/2025 Department of Human Development and Family Science
Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, Virginia, USA
Assistant Professor

09/2017 - 07/2018 Department of Psychology
Rutgers University-Newark, New Jersey, USA
Postdoctoral Fellow (PI: Dr. Elizabeth Bonawitz)

07/2016 - 06/2017 Department of Psychology
University of California, Riverside, California, USA
Postdoctoral Scholar (PI: Dr. Rebekah Richert)

AFFILIATED POSITIONS

2025 - Present The Center for Human-Computer Interaction Affiliated Faculty Member
2023 - Present The Whole Health Consortium Affiliated Faculty Member
2019 - 2022 The Center for Humanities Affiliated Faculty Member

RESEARCH INTERESTS

As a developmental scientist, my research program centers on the role of technology in cognitive development in early childhood to better understand and support young children's attention and learning in complex and dynamic technological landscapes. I focus on two complementary lines of research. The first area examines children's learning from interactive and emerging technologies, including touchscreens, AI, and social robots. The second area investigates attentional processes and family contextual factors related to children's technology use. I translate my research into practice to inform parents, educators, content creators, developers, health professionals, and policymakers about how to effectively use technology to support children and their families.

PUBLICATIONS

[U]Undergraduate student mentee; [G]Graduate student mentee;
[P]Postdoctoral fellow mentee;
*Corresponding author

Peer reviewed journal articles

[27] 13 corresponding author (6 first author, 2 co-first author, 5 senior author), 1 first author, 13 co-author

2026

27. *Zettersten, M., **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., & Saffran, J. R. (in press). Active sampling helps children learn new words by tuning their curriculum to past experiences. *Journal of Experimental Psychology*

26. [G]Gürdal, M. S., [P]Özcan, M. Ş. (co-first), Smith, C. L., & ***Choi, K.** (2026). Effortful control and media use from birth to age 5: A meta-analysis. *Media Psychology*, 1–36. https://doi.org/10.1080/15213269.2026.2738788

25. [G]*Walker, A., Quesenberry, E., Morris, K., Gürdal, M., Yu, S., **Choi, K.**, Katz, B., & Jeon, M. (2026). False memories: Subjective and objective responses to an "accented" voice assistant. *Phonetica*. https://doi.org/10.1515/phon-2025-0080

24. [G]Gürdal, M. S., ***Choi, K.**, & Smith, C. L. (2026). Suppress or reappraise? Differential roles of maternal emotion regulation strategies in mothers' and toddlers' interactive and non-interactive screen media use. *Infant Behavior and Development, 84*, 102203. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.infbeh.2026.102203

23. [G]Choe, M., Walker, A., **Choi, K.**, Kilp, N., & *Jeon, M. (2026). Voice agent accents can shape driver behavior and perception. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies,* 103776. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijhcs.2026.103776

22. [G]Yu, S., ***Choi, K. (co-first)**, [G]Kim, J., [G]Dong, J., [G]Lee, Y., Haines, C., Newbill, P., Wyatt, A., Upthegrove, T. & Jeon, M. (2026). Child-robot musical theater for early childhood STEAM education: A case study in classrooms. *Early Childhood Education Journal, 54*(5), 3997-4013. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10643-026-02135-6

21. [P]Özcan, M. Ş., *Hong, Y., & ***Choi, K.** (2026). Early media use predicts later executive function difficulties through problematic media use: A cross-lagged panel model

in middle childhood with an early childhood media use predictor. *Media Psychology*, 1–27. https://doi.org/10.1080/15213269.2026.2618675

2025

20. [G]Dong, J., [G]Yu, S., **Choi, K.**, & *Jeon, M. (2025). A child-robot theater after-school program can facilitate children's conceptualization of social robots' mental capacities and engagement in learning. *Frontiers in Robotics and AI, 12*, 1529421. https://doi.org/10.3389/frobt.2025.1529421

19. *[G]Vargas-Diaz, D., [G]Kim, J., [G]Karunaratna, S., Hornburg, C. B., **Choi, K.**, & Lee, S. (2025). Exploring parent involvement in e-book joint reading with voice agents. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies, 198*, 103461. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijhcs.2025.103461

18. **Choi, K.**, & *Hong, Y. (2025). Differential roles of problematic media use by mothers and toddlers in the relation between parenting stress and toddlers' socioemotional development. *Infant Behavior and Development, 78*, 102009. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.infbeh.2024.102009

2024

17. [G]*Wong, M., ***Choi, K. (co-first)**, Barak, L., Lapidow, E., Austin, J., Shafto, P., & *Bonawitz, E. (2024). Young children's directed question asking in preschool classrooms. *Behavioral Sciences, 14*(9), 754. https://doi.org/10.3390/bs14090754

16. [G]Dong, J., **Choi, K.**, [G]Yu, S., [G]Lee, Y., [G]Kim, J., [U]Vajir, D., Hains, C., Newbill, P., Wyatt, A., Upthegrove, T. & *Jeon, M. (2024). A child-robot musical theater afterschool program for promoting STEAM education: A case study and guidelines. *International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction, 40*(13), 3465-3481. https://doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2023.2189814

2023

15. ***Choi, K.** (2023). Understanding early learning in an evolving digital media landscape. *Journal of Applied Research in Memory and Cognition, 12*(4), 476-479. https://doi.org/10.1037/mac0000146

2022

14. ***Choi, K.**, Schlesinger, M. A., Franchak, J. M, & Richert, R. A. (2022). Preschoolers' attention to and learning from on-screen characters that vary by effort and efficiency: An eye-tracking study. *Frontiers in Psychology, 13*, 1011172. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.1011172

13. *Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, Etta, R. A, & Yoo, S. H. (2022). The impact of touchscreen interactivity on U.S. toddlers' selective attention and learning from digital media. *Journal of Children and Media, 16*(2), 188-204. https://doi.org/10.1080/17482798.2021.1944888

2021

12. ***Choi, K.** (2021). Sesame Street: Beyond 50. *Journal of Children and Media, 15*(4), 597-603. https://doi.org/10.1080/17482798.2021.1978675

11. [G]*Macias, C., & ***Choi, K.** (2021). Preschoolers' beliefs about media technologies: The role of family income. *Human Behavior and Emerging Technologies, 3(4)*, 572-584. https://doi.org/10.1002/hbe2.278

10. *Rosengren, K., Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, Jiang, M. J., [U]Raimer, C., [U]Tolkin, E., & [U]Sartin-Tarm, A. (2021). Attempting to break the fourth wall: Young children's action errors with screen media *Human Behavior and Emerging Technologies, 3(4)*, 468-483. https://doi.org/10.1002/hbe2.273

9. [G]Shin, E., ***Choi, K.**, [G]Resor, J., & Smith, C. L. (2021). Why do parents use screen media with toddlers? The role of child temperament and parenting stress in early screen use. *Infant Behavior and Development, 64*, 101595. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.infbeh.2021.101595

8. ***Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., & Pempek, T. A. (2021). Touchscreens for whom? Working memory and age moderate the impact of contingency on toddlers' transfer from video. *Frontiers in Psychology, 12*, 621372. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2021.621372

2020 **7**. *Kirkorian, H. L., Travers, B., Jiang, M., **Choi, K.**, Rosengren K. S., [U]Pavalko P., & [U]Tolkin, E. (2020). Drawing across media: A cross-sectional experiment on preschoolers' drawings produced using traditional versus electronic mediums. *Developmental Psychology, 56*(1), 28-39. https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0000825

2019 **6**. *Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, & Anderson, D. R. (2019). American parents' active engagement mediates the impact of background television on toddlers' play. *Journal of Children and Media, 13*(4), 377-394. https://doi.org/10.1080/17482798.2019.1635033

2018 **5**. ***Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., & Pempek, T. A. (2018). Understanding the transfer deficit: Contextual mismatch, proactive interference, and working memory affect toddlers' video-based transfer. *Child Development, 89*(4), 1378-1393. https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.12810

4. *Travers, B. G., Kirkorian, H. L., Jiang, M. J., **Choi, K.**, Rosengren, K. S., [U]Pavalko, P., & [U]Jobin, P. (2018). Knowing how to fold 'em: Paper folding across early childhood. *Journal of Motor Learning and Development, 6*(1), 147-166. https://doi.org/10.1123/jmld.2016-0044

2017 **3**. *Kirkorian, H. L., & **Choi, K.** (2017). Associations between toddlers' naturalistic media experience and observed learning from screens. *Infancy, 22*(2), 271-277. https://doi.org/10.1111/infa.12171

2016 **2**. ***Choi, K.**, & Kirkorian, H. L. (2016). Touch or watch to learn? Toddlers' object retrieval using contingent and noncontingent video. *Psychological Science, 27*(5), 726-736. https://doi.org/10.1177/0956797616636110

1. *Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, & Pempek, T. A. (2016). Toddlers' word learning from contingent and noncontingent video on touch screens. *Child Development, 87*(2),

405-413. https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.12508

Manuscripts under review [6] 3 corresponding author (3 senior author), 3 co-author

6. [G]*Mubassira, M, Bejarano, A, [P]Özcan, M. Ş., [G]*Chen, J., Gulseven, Z., **Choi, K.**, Zhu, Q., & Jeon, M. (under review). AI and robot ethics education for elementary school children: A systematic review of ethical frameworks and pedagogical approaches.
5. [G] *Gürdal, M. S., Çarık, B., Shin, E., Smith, C. L., & ***Choi, K.** (under review). What factors matter most for toddler media use? A theory-informed machine learning investigation
4. [G]Hou, J., Xiong, X., Chen, Z., Chen, J., He, D., **Choi, K.**, Long, H., & Chen, Q. (in revision). Endorsing AI while favoring humans: The dynamics of bias against generative AI in artistic creativity.
3. [G]Chen, J., Wang, Z., Shin, E., Smith, L., & ***Choi, K.** (revised and resubmitted). Mapping parental factors in toddlers' media use: A network analysis approach.
2. [G]Kim, J., & ***Choi, K.** (in minor revision). Understanding preschoolers' learning from socially contingent video chat: Effects of contextual, child, and design factors.
1. [G]*Gürdal, M. S., Smith, C. L., **Choi, K.**, & Bell, M. A. (minor revision resubmitted). Childhood temperament and adolescent problematic media use: A longitudinal multi-informant study in the United States.

Selected Manuscripts in Preparation [8] 7 corresponding author (6 senior author) and 1 co-author

8. [G]*Devine, D., Smith, C. L., & **Choi, K.** (in preparation). Caregiver technology use: Associations with caregiver involvement and sensitivity during free play with young children.
7. [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & *Choi, K. (in preparation). Not all screen time is equal: Digital media and executive functions in preschoolers.
6. [G]Gürdal, M. S., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., [G]Chen, J., [G]Yu, S., [G]Li, Z., [G]Colbert, M. A., [G]Pyon, J., Lee, S. W., Hornburg, C. B., & *Choi, K. (in preparation). The impact of AI on preschoolers' learning during parent–child shared e-book reading.
5. [G]Beers, C., [G]Yu, S., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., Smith, C. L. & ***Choi, K.** (in preparation). Feeling guilty around child's screen use: The associations among parental awareness, agreeableness, and adherence related to media guidelines, child screen use, and maternal media guilt.
4. [G]Yu, S., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & ***Choi, K.** (in preparation). Predictors of media use and problematic media use in autistic children.

3. [G]Kim, J., Hornburg, C., & ***Choi, K.** (in preparation). Preschoolers' mathematical language learning during book reading with an AI voice agent.

2. [G]Chen, J., [G] Gürdal, M. S., *Hong, Y., & ***Choi, K.** (in preparation). The interplay between problematic smartphone use, depression, and creative personality in adolescents: A longitudinal cross-lagged model.

1. [G]Yilar, I., Grados, M., Bonawitz, E., & ***Choi, K.** (in preparation). Child-led play supports parents to make flexible and exploratory causal inferences.

BOOK CHAPTERS (PUBLISHED AND UNDER REVIEW) [6] 2 corresponding author (2 first author), 4 co-author (1 senior author)

2026

6. ***Choi, K.** (under review). AI literacy and cognitive development: Learning, interaction, and responsible AI (Invited). In H. Song, J. Sung, T. Lee, J. Lee, G. Ko, K. Choi, H. Lee, & M. Eom, *Children's and adolescents' growth and development in the age of AI: Opportunities and challenges*. Hakjisa. [In Korean]

5. *Kim, J., Hornburg, C. B., Lee, S. W., & **Choi, K.** (in revision). Talking math: Supporting early mathematics learning through AI-mediated storybook reading. In K. Robinson, A. Dubé, & D. Kotsopoulos (Eds.), *Thinking numbers, thinking machines: Mathematical learning and cognition in the GenAI age*.

2025

4. ***Choi, K.**, & Jeon, M. (2025). Child-robot musical theater for diverse and inclusive STREAMS education for children. In D. Huffman, K. Feldman, & I. Herrick (Eds.), *STEM to STREAMS: Towards a more equitable vision of STEM education (pp. 51-72)*. Rowman & Littlefield.

3. *Richert, R. A., **Choi, K.**, Gleason, T.R., Goldstein, T.R., & Sibert, S.M. (2025). Imagination, creativity, and play. In D.A. Christakis, & L. Hale (Eds.), *Handbook of children and screens (pp. 47-53)*. Springer, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-69362-5_7

2017

2. *Kirkorian, H. L., Pempek, T. A., & **Choi, K.** (2017). The role of online processing in young children's ability to learn from interactive and noninteractive media. In R. Barr & D. Linebarger (Eds.), *Media exposure during infancy and early childhood: The effect of content and context on learning and development (pp. 65-89)*. Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-45102-2_5

2011

1. *Yi, S., Kim, M., Gun, K., Jung, J., Song, M., & **Choi, K.** (2011). *Early childhood education program of intergenerational integration: Integrating early childhood program series*. Seoul: Hakjisa.

PEER REVIEWED PAPERS IN CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

[10] 2 corresponding author (2 first author), 2 senior, 6 co-author

2026

10. [G]Pyon, J., **Choi, K.**, Kim, Y.-H., & Lee, S. W. (accepted). JENNIE: Joint expression of narrative, nurturing, inquiry, and engagement. *Companion Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2026)*.

9. [G]*Karunaratna, S., [G]Vargas-Diaz, D., [G]Kim, J., Wang, J., Lee, S., & **Choi, K.** (2026). *When less can be more: Evaluating the impact of animated and interactive demonstrations in voice-assisted counting games for young children.* In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems. Article 956, 1–16. https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791550

2025

8. [G]Choe, M., [U]Kilp, N., Walker, A., **Choi, K.,** & *Jeon, M. (2025). How does an in-vehicle agent accent influence driver behavior and perception? *Proceedings of the Human Factors and Ergonomics Society Annual Meeting*, 69, 1925-1928

2024

7. [G]Karunaratna, S., [G]Vargas-Diaz, D., [G]Kim, J., Wang, J., **Choi, K.**, & *Lee, S. (2024). Evaluation of interactive demonstration in voice-assisted counting for young children. *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing* (CSCW), San José, Costa Rica, November 9-13. https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3678884.3681886

6. [G]Dong, J., [G]Mitchell, J. J., [G]Yu, S., [U]Harmon, M., [U]Holstein, A., [G]Shim, J. H., **Choi, K.**, Zhu, Q., & *Jeon, M. (2024). Promoting STEAM education and AI/robot ethics in a child-robot theater afterschool program. *Proceedings of the ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI)*, Boulder, CO, March 11-15. IEEE. https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3610978.3641110

5. [G]Mitchell, J. J., [G]Dong, J., [G]Yu, S., [U]Harmon, M., [U]Holstein, A., [G]Shim, J. H., **Choi, K.**, Zhu, Q., & *Jeon, M. (2024). Bridging the gap: Early education on robot and AI ethics through the robot theater platform in an informal learning environment. *Proceedings of the ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI)*, Boulder, CO, March 11-15. IEEE. https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3610978.3640581

2023

4. [G]*Vargas-Diaz, D., [G]Karunaratna, S., [G]Kim, J., Lee, S., & **Choi, K.** (2023). TaleMate: Collaborating with voice agents for parent-child joint reading experiences. *Adjunct Proceedings of the 36th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology*. Online. https://doi.org/10.1145/3586182.3616699

2022

3. [G]Lee, Y., Wyatt, A., [G]Dong, J., Upthegrove, T., Hale, B., Lyles, C. H., **Choi, K.**, [G]Kim, J., [G]Yu, S., [U]Vajir, D., Newbill, P., & Jeon, M. (2022). Robot musical theater for climate change education. *Proceedings of the 2022 ACM/IEEE International*

Conference on Human-Robot Interaction. Online.
https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.5555/3523760.3523895

2019 **2.** ***Choi, K.**, [U]Grados, M., & Bonawitz, E. (2019). Observing child-led exploration improves parents' causal inferences. *Proceedings of the 41th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*. Montreal, Canada: Cognitive Science Society.
https://mindmodeling.org/cogsci2019/papers/0272/index.html

2018 **1.** ***Choi, K.**, [G]Lapidow, E., Austin, J., Shafto, P., & Bonawitz, E. (2018). Preschoolers are more likely to direct learning content questions to adults than to other children (or selves) during spontaneous conversational acts. *Proceedings of the 40th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*. Madison, WI: Cognitive Science Society.
http://mindmodeling.org/cogsci2018/papers/0061/index.html

RESEARCH SUPPORT

Extramural Funding

Active

2025-2028 • *Responsible robot and AI literacy: Embodied informal learning on ethical robotics and AI through a creative afterschool program*
- National Science Foundation (Computer and Information Science and Engineering: Core)
- Awarded: $500,000
- Myounghoon Jeon (PI); **Koeun Choi (Co-PI)**, Qin Zhu (Co-PI)

2025-2027 • *A behavioral and neural investigation of young children's attention and comprehension on interactive video viewing platforms*
- National Institutes of Health (R03)
- Awarded: $150,803
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Martha Ann Bell, Sang Won Lee (Co-PIs)

2025-2026 • *Supporting playful parent-child joint reading experiences through AI digital technology*
- Caplan Foundation for Early Childhood
- Awarded: $58,320
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Caroline Hornburg, Sang Won Lee (Co-PIs)

Pending

2027-2030 • *Collaborative Research: Large-Number Counting with AI Assistance in Informal Learning Contexts for 5- to 6-Year-Old Children*
- National Science Foundation (NSF)
- Requested (Pending): $754,924
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Sang Won Lee (Co-PI)

Intramural Funding

Completed

2025-2026
- *StorySpace: Investigating the role of semantic distance in children's creative storytelling*
  - College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences Niles Research Grant
  - Awarded: $4,000
  - **Koeun Choi (PI)**

2024-2025
- *Developmental Science at Virginia Tech Network centralized website development and registry expansion*
  - Institute for Society, Culture, and Environment (ISCE) Unsolicited Grant
  - Awarded: $14,500
  - **Koeun Choi (MPI, Contact PI)**; Caroline Hornburg, Robin Panneton, and Zehra Gulseven (MPIs)

2024-2025
- *Reimagining early learning through AI-enhanced parent-child playful joint reading*
  - Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) SEAD Mini Grant
  - Awarded: $6,000
  - **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Caroline Hornburg, Sang Won Lee (Co-PIs)

2023-2025
- *Storybook reading with an AI voice assistant to promote preschoolers' mathematics learning*
  - Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) Steve and Karen Johns/CENI SEAD Grant
  - Awarded: $3,000
  - **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Myounghoon Jeon, Caroline Hornburg, Shannon Mury, Jisun Kim, Daniel Vargas-Diaz, Yeaji Lee (Co-PIs)

2023-2024
- *Collaborative research on conversational artificial intelligence (AI)*
  - Faculty Affairs Faculty Writing Group Grant
  - Awarded: $2,000
  - **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Yan Chen, Michael Hsiao, Abby Walker, Myounghoon Jeon (Co-PIs)

2023-2024
- *Integrating AI voice assistants into touchscreens for young children's interactive math learning*
  - Institute for Society, Culture, and Environment (ISCE) Scholars Program Award
  - Awarded: $30,000
  - **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Sang Won Lee, Jenny Jinjing Wang (Co-PIs)

2023 • *The voice of voice assistants*
- Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) and Institute for Society, Culture, and Environment (ISCE) Grant
- Awarded: $22,000
- Abby Walker (PI); Myounghoon Jeon, Sang Won Lee, **Koeun Choi (Co-PI)**, Charlie Klauer (Co-PIs)

2022-2023 • *Children's story time in a digital world: Preschoolers' math learning from shared digital book reading with a voice assistant*
- College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences Niles Research Grant
- Awarded: $5,500
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**

2022-2023 • *Evaluating commercial screen-based devices for children's connection and engagement with remote contacts*
- Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) Mini Grant
- Awarded: $2,912
- Neelma Bhatti (PI); **Koeun Choi (Co-PI)**, Scott McCrickard, Aisling Kelliher (Co-PIs)

2021-2023 • *Robot musical theater for promoting STEAM education and integrated art performances*
- Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) SEAD Grant; Center for Human-Computer Interaction (CHCI) matching funds
- Awarded: $26,000
- Myounghoon Jeon (PI); **Koeun Choi (Co-PI)**, Phyllis Newbill, Tanner Upthegrove, Ariana Wyatt, Chelsea Lyles (Co-PIs)

2019-2021 • *Mobile learning across the life span: Processing and learning information from mobile media technology in children, young adults, and older adults*
- Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) Science, Engineering, Art, and Design (SEAD) Grant
- Awarded: $25,000
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Benjamin Katz, Adrienne Holz Ivory, Gota Morota (Co-PIs)

2019-2020 • *Children's and adults' selective learning from human, print, and digital information sources*
- College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences Niles Research Grant
- Awarded: $5,000
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**

2019 • *Child temperament and early screen time: The mediating role of parental stress*
- Institute for Society, Culture, and Environment (ISCE) Unsolicited Grant
- Awarded: $4,360
- **Koeun Choi (PI)**; Cynthia L. Smith (Co-PI)

TRAINEE FELLOWSHIP AND AWARD

[7] Advisees on awards supporting lab projects

Active

2026-2027
- *Understanding the associations between video viewing and creativity in early childhood*
  - Graduate Research Development Program Grant, Virginia Tech
  - Awarded: $1,100
  - Faculty Sponsor Supporting Jing Chen

2026-2027
- *Understanding preschoolers' problematic media use through temperamental reactivity and regulation with a new digital frustration task*
  - Psi Chi Research Grant
  - Awarded: $1,525
  - Faculty Sponsor Supporting Mahmut Sami Gürdal

2025-2027
- *Media effects on cognitive development*
  - Virginia Tech Presidential Postdoctoral Fellowship
  - Awarded: $171,526 (PI: $69,736, Fellowship: $101,790)
  - Meryem Şeyda Özcan (Postdoctoral Fellow); Koeun Choi (Faculty Sponsor)

2024-2027
- *STEMEdIPRF: Looking beyond screen time: Exploring the relationship between diverse media experience, educational expectations, and learning in children*
  - Postdoctoral Fellowship, National Science Foundation
  - Awarded: $342,906
  - Carla Macias (PI); Kimele Persaud (Faculty Primary Sponsor), Koeun Choi (Faculty Co-Sponsor)

Completed

2024-2025
- *Understanding the role of digital media on young children's executive functions*
  - Visiting Scholar Scholarship, Scientific and Technological Research Council of Türkiye
  - Awarded: $22,800
  - Faculty Sponsor Supporting Meryem Şeyda Özcan

2023-2024
- *How ethnicity and neurodiversity affect caregivers' ideal affect: An exploratory study comparing Asian and European American parents of children with autism and without autism*
  - Graduate Research Grant, Organization for Autism Research
  - Awarded $1,343
  - Faculty Sponsor Supporting Shuqi Yu

2023-2024 • *Shared book reading with an AI voice assistant for preschoolers' mathematical language learning*
- Graduate Research and Development Program Dissertation Award, Virginia Tech
- Total Award: $850
- Faculty Sponsor Supporting Jisun Kim

AWARDS, HONORS, AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT GRANTS

2026 • Excellence in Research and Creative Scholarship Award ($500), College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech

2025 • Filp the Fair Curious Questioner Award, Virginia Tech

2024 • ICAT Creativity + Innovation Day Museum's Choice Award, Virginia Tech

2023 • Dennis Dean Undergraduate Research and Creative Scholarship Conference Service Learning and Research Award (Student Poster), Virginia Tech
• Institute for Society, Culture, and Environment (ISCE) Support for Summer Institute Course, Virginia Tech ($1,200)

2022 • ICAT Creativity + Innovation Day Judges' Choice Award (Robot Musical Theater STEAM Team), Virginia Tech

2021 • Outstanding Undergraduate Research Mentor Award, Office of Undergraduate Research, Virginia Tech

2019 • Professional Development Grant ($2,000; 2019-2022), The Center For Humanities, Virginia Tech
• New Faculty Mentoring Grant ($1,500), Virginia Tech

2018 • Top Paper Award, Children, Adolescents, and Media Division, International Communication Association (ICA; Kirkorian, **Choi, K.**, Yoo, & Etta)

2017 • Top Paper Award, Children, Adolescents, and Media Division, International Communication Association (ICA; Kirkorian, **Choi, K.**, & Anderson)
• Early Career Travel Award ($500), Society for Research in Child Development

2016 • Human Development & Family Studies Outstanding Research Award ($400), UW-Madison

2015 • Sackler Colloquia National Academy of Sciences Travel Award ($1,000), National Academy of Sciences
• Schurch-Thomson Graduate Research Award ($2,000), UW-Madison
• Human Development & Family Studies Summer Research Award ($1,500), UW-Madison

2014 • Human Development & Family Studies Summer Research Award ($1,500), UW-Madison
• Meyers Fund of the School of Human Ecology Travel Award ($500/yr; 2014-2016), UW-Madison

2013
- Human Development & Family Studies Travel Award ($500/yr; 2013-2016), UW-Madison
- McPherson ERI David G. Walsh Research Travel Award ($1,000), UW-Madison
- Viola Baker Endowment School of Human Ecology Travel Award ($500), UW-Madison
- Human Development & Family Studies Outstanding Research Scholarship Award, UW-Madison
- Graduate Student Travel Award ($300), Society for Research in Child Development

2012
- Korean Honor Scholarship ($1,000), Embassy of the Republic of Korea

2010
- Graduate Student Award ($500), Korea Institute of Child Care & Education

2003
- Seoul National University Entrance Scholarship, Seoul National University

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Extramural Presentations

[24] 10 domestic and 14 international

2026

24. **Choi, K.** (2026, December 16). *Children and technology.* Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea. (Scheduled)

23. **Choi, K.** (2026, December 15). *Children and technology.* Jeonbuk National University, Jeonju, South Korea. (Scheduled)

22. **Choi, K.** (2026, December 14). *Children and technology.* Yonsei University, Seoul, South Korea. (Scheduled)

21. **Choi, K.** (2026, November 10). *Technology-based psychological data collection and analysis with children.* Inha University, Incheon, South Korea. Virtual. (Scheduled)

20. **Choi, K.** (2026, October 14). *Interactive technology and children's cognitive development.* Applied Developmental Psychology Colloquium Series, George Mason University, Fairfax, VA, United States. (Scheduled)

19. **Choi, K.** (2026, July 3). *AI and child development: Learning, interaction, and responsible AI* [Invited keynote presentation]. 2026 Department of Child and Adolescent Studies Joint International Conference, Sungkyunkwan University, Seoul, South Korea.

2025

18. **Choi, K.** (2025, December 17). *Children's Learning with Technology.* Laboratory of Biometry and Bioinformatics, Department of Agricultural and Environmental Biology, The University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan.

17. **Choi, K.** (2025, April 4). *Media and naturalistic measures.* Departmental Workshop, Department of Psychology, Rutgers University-New Brunswick, Virtual.

2024

16. **Choi, K.** (2024, December 10). *Cognitive Developmental Science Lab at Virginia Tech.* The Comprehensive Assessment of Family Media Exposure (CAFE) Virtual International Summit, Virtual.

2023 **15**. **Choi, K.** (2023, December 16). *Digital technology and child development* [Invited keynote presentation]. Korean Association of Psychotherapy For Children, South Korea. Virtual.

2022 **14**. **Choi, K.** (2022, May 20). *Cognitive development in the context of digital technology.* Global Psychological Science Webinar at Yonsei University, South Korea. Virtual.

2021 **13**. **Choi, K.** (2021, November 26). *Young children's digital media use and safety.* The Meeting of the Korean Association of Human Ecology, South Korea. Virtual.

12. **Choi, K.** (2021, November 13). *Digital media and child development.* The Meeting of the Korean Society for Developmental Psychology, South Korea. Virtual.

11. **Choi, K.** (2021, May 14). *Cognitive development and digital technology.* Department of Bio and Brain Engineering, Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST), South Korea. Virtual.

2019 **10**. **Choi, K.** (2019, August 5). *Children and technology: Understanding cognitive development in digital contexts.* Department of Child Development and Family Studies, Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea.

2018 **9**. **Choi, K.** (2018, December 6). *Children's transfer of learning from interactive media technology.* Center for Humanities, Virginia Tech, VA, United States.

8. **Choi, K.** (2018, October 26). *Children's transfer of learning from interactive media technology.* Department of Psychology, Hollins University, VA, United States.

7. **Choi, K.** (2018. October 15). *Children's transfer of learning from interactive media technology.* National Institute of Education, Singapore.

6. **Choi, K.** (2018, June 1). *Parent-child conjunctive play helps parents to think more flexibly.* Guiding Guided Play Workshop, Newark, NJ, United States.

5. **Choi, K.** (2018, January 8). *Understanding cognitive development in digital media environments.* Department of Human Development & Family Science, Virginia Tech, United States.

2017 **4**. **Choi, K.** (2017, October). *Interactions with touch screens improve toddlers' transfer independent of individual differences in working memory.* Cognitive Development Society Pre-Conference Workshop on Digital Media & Cognitive Development, Portland, OR, United States.

2016 **3**. **Choi, K.** (2016, March). *Touch or watch to learn? Children's learning from interactive & non-interactive symbolic media.* Developmental Brown Bag, Department of Psychology, UW-Madison, WI, United States.

2015 **2**. **Choi, K.** (2015, December). *Touch or watch to learn? Children's learning from interactive media, Children's Digital Media Center.* Georgetown University, WA, United States.

2014 **1**. **Choi, K.** (2014, December). *Eye movements as a window into children's learning from visual media, McPherson Eye Research Institution Seminar.* UW-Madison, WI, United States.

PEER-REVIEWED PRESENTATIONS [U]Undergraduate student mentee; [G]Graduate student mentee; [P]Postdoctoral fellow mentee

2026

81. [G]Chen, J., Wang, Z., Shin, E., Smith, C., & **Choi, K.** (2026, June 21-25). Mapping parental factors in toddlers' media use: A network analysis approach [Poster Presentation]. The 28th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development (ISSBD), Incheon, South Korea.

80. [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & **Choi, K.** (2026, June 21-25). Media use and executive functions in preschoolers: Testing mediators and moderators [Poster Presentation]. The 28th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development (ISSBD), Incheon, South Korea.

79. [P]Özcan, M. Ş., Hong, Y., & **Choi, K.** (2026, June 23). Early childhood media use predicts later executive function difficulties through problematic use in middle childhood [Paper Presentation]. The 28th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development (ISSBD), Incheon, South Korea.

78. [G]Devine, D., Smith, C. L., & **Choi, K.** (2026, June 25). Differential caregiving behavior within multiple technology contexts [Paper Presentation]. The 28th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development (ISSBD), Incheon, South Korea.

77. **Choi, K.**, [P]Özcan, M. Ş., [G]Gürdal, M. S., [G]Chen, J., [G]Colbert, M. A., Hornburg, C. B., & Lee, S. W. (2026, June 23). The impact of AI support on preschoolers' learning during parent-child shared e-book reading: Lab-based evidence [Paper Presentation]. The 28th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development (ISSBD), Incheon, South Korea.

76. [G]Gürdal, M. S., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., [G]Chen, J., [G]Colbert, M. A., Lee, S. W., Hornburg, C. B., & **Choi, K.** (2026, April 9–11). *Who reads the story matters: The impact of AI on preschoolers' learning during parent–child shared e-book reading* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

75. [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & **Choi, K.** (2026, April 9–11). *Family media practices linked to problematic media use in early childhood* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

74. [P]Macias, C., **Choi, K.**, & Persaud, K. (2026, April 9–11). *Parental perspective: The role of parental digital media belief in children's media beliefs, memory, and transfer learning of educational content* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

73. [G]Yu, S., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & **Choi, K.** (2026, April 9–11). *Predictors of media use and problematic media use in autistic children: The roles of child and parental factors* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

72. [G]Chen, J., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., Wang, Z., & **Choi, K.** (2026, April 9–11). *Examining interrelations among temperament, media use, and behavioral problems in early childhood* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

71. [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & **Choi, K.** (2026, April 9). *Using EEG to study online processing of*

digital media in young children [Methodology flash talk]. Children and Technology: Emerging Scholars, Emerging Methods, Emerging Directions, Pre-Conference Workshop of the Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

70. [P]Macias, C., Persaud, K., & **Choi, K.** (2026, April 9). *Preschoolers' beliefs about media technologies and their role in memory and learning from digital educational content* [Workshop presentation]. Children and Technology: Emerging Scholars, Emerging Methods, Emerging Directions, Pre-Conference Workshop of the Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, QC, Canada.

2025

69. [G]Gürdal, M. S., Smith, C. L., Shin, L., & **Choi, K.** (2025, November 6-9). *When temperaments align: Toddler temperament as a moderator between parental personality and media use motivations* [Paper presentation]. The 25th Occasional Temperament Conference, College Station, TX, United States.

68. [P]Macias, C., Kimele, P. & **Choi, K.** (2025, July 13-16). *Young children's beliefs about and learning from digital media* [Poster presentation]. Children and Screens, Washington DC, United States.

67. [G]Özcan, M. Ş., & **Choi, K.** (2025, July 13-16). *Exploring the role of child temperament, parental stress, and disruptive phone use in preschoolers' problematic media use* [Poster Presentation]. Children and Screens, Washington DC, United States.

66. [G]Chen, J., Hong, Y., & **Choi, K.** (2025, July 13-16). *The interplay between problematic smartphone use, depression, and creative personality in adolescents: A longitudinal cross-lagged model* [Flash Talk & Poster Presentation]. Children and Screens, Washington DC, United States.

65. [G]Gürdal, M. S., Smith, C., **Choi, K.**, & Bell, M.A. (2025, July 13-16). *From early temperament to later problematic media use: The mediating role of adolescent temperament* [Paper Presentation]. Children and Screens, Washington DC, United States.

64. Smith, C. L., [G]Özcan, M. S., [G]Gürdal, M. S., Shin, L., & **Choi, K.** (2025, May 1-3). *Children's regulation starts with the parents: A latent profile analysis of parent emotion regulation strategies* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN, United States.

63. [G]Chen, J., Wang, J., Shin, L., Smith, C., & **Choi, K.** (2025, May 1-3). *Parental beliefs about media's value in creativity: The role of media interactivity, motives, and openness* [Poster Presentation (5/1)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN, United States.

62. [G]Kim, J., Hornburg, C., & **Choi, K.** (2025, May 1-3). *Preschoolers' mathematical language learning during shared book reading with an Al voice agent* [Paper Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN, United States.

2024

61. [G]Vargas-Diaz, D., [G]Kim, J., [G]Karunaratna, S., [G]Reinhardt, M. A., Hornburg, C. B., **Choi, K.**, & Lee, S. W. (2024, May 11). *TaleMate: Exploring the use of voice agents for parent-child joint reading experiences* [Paper Presentation (5/11)]. CHI 2024 Workshop on Child-centered AI Design, Honolulu, HI, United States.

60. [G]Kim, J., [G]Vargas-Diaz, D., Mury, S., Hornburg, C. B., & **Choi, K.** (2024, May

11). *Preschoolers' mathematical language learning during book reading with an AI smart speaker* [Paper Presentation (5/11)]. CHI 2024 Workshop on Child-centered AI Design, Honolulu, HI, United States.

59. Walker, A., **Choi, K.**, [G]Gürdal, M. S., [G]Yu, S., Katz, B., Jeon, M., [U]Morris, K., [U]Odom, C., [U]Kebede, L., & [U]Quesenberry, E. (2024, April 4-7). *The impact of voice assistant accent on user experience* [Paper Presentation (4/6)]. Southeastern Conference on Linguistics, Athens, GA, United States.

58. [G]Gürdal, M. S., **Choi, K.**, Shin, E., & Smith, C. (2024, March 21-23). *Understanding parental factors associated with toddlers' video viewing: A chained mediation model investing the roles of parental emotion regulation, media use, stress, and media use motive* [Poster Presentation (3/22)]. Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Pasadena, CA, United States.

57. [G]Yu, S., [G]Beers, C., Smith, C. L., & **Choi, K.** (2024, March 21-23). *Feeling guilty around child's screen use: The associations among parental awareness, agreeableness, and adherence related to media guidelines, child screen use, and maternal media guilt* [Poster Presentation (3/22)]. Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Pasadena, CA, United States.

56. [G]Kim, J., [G]Vargas-Diaz, D., Mury, S., Hornburg, C. B., & **Choi, K.** (2024, March 21-23). *Preschoolers' mathematical language learning during book reading with an AI smart speaker* [Poster Presentation (3/22)]. Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Pasadena, CA, United States.

2023

55. [G]Kim, J., [G]Vargas-Diaz, D., [G]Karunaratna, S., Mury, S., Lee, S., Hornburg, C. B., & **Choi, K.**. (2023, October 19-20). *AI conversational agents for preschoolers' mathematical language learning and engagement* [Poster Presentation]. Emerging Perspectives in Early STEM Learning, Development, and Education Workshop, West Lafayette, IN, United States.

54. **Choi, K.**, [G]Yu, S., [G]Kim, J., [G]Dong, J., [G]Lee, Y., Haines, C., Newbill, P., Upthegrove, T., Wyatt, A., & Jeon, M. (2023, April 13-16). *Interactive stories through robot musical theater for preschoolers' STEAM education* [Paper Presentation (4/15)]. Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association, Chicago, IL, United States.

53. [G]Kim, J., & **Choi, K.** (2023, March 23-25). *The impact of questions on preschoolers' learning from shared book reading over video chat* [Paper Presentation (3/23)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT, United States.

52. [G]Yu, S., **Choi, K.**, Kim, J., Dong, J., Lee, Y., Haines, C., Newbill, P., Upthegrove, T., Wyatt, A., & Jeon, M. (2023, March 23-25). *Robot musical theater for preschoolers' STEAM education: Effects on interest, self-efficacy, and curiosity in technology* [Paper Presentation (3/23)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT, United States.

51. [G]Gürdal, M. S., **Choi, K.**, [G]Shin, E., [G]Kim, J., [G]Yu, S., & Smith, C. (2023, March 23-25). Associations of maternal emotion regulation and mothers' and toddlers' screen use [Paper Presentation (3/24)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT, United States.

2022

49. [G]Yu, S., [G]Dong, J., [G]Kim, J., [G]Lee, Y., [U]Vajir, D., Lyles, C. H., Newbill, P., Upthegrove, T., Wyatt, A., Jeon, M., & **Choi, K.** (2022, April 21-23). *Sing, act, and dance with robots: A child-robot musical theater afterschool program for STEAM education* [Poster Presentation (4/23)]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society. Madison, WI, United States.

48. [G]Kim, J., & **Choi, K.** (2022, April 21-23). *Q&A on Zoom for preschoolers: The impact of on-screen partner's questions on preschoolers' word learning and memory of content from shared book reading over video chat* [Poster Presentation (4/23)]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society. Madison, WI, United States.

47. **Choi, K.**, [G]Yu, S., [G]Dong, J., [G]Kim, J., [G]Lee, Y., [U]Vajir, D., Lyles, C. H., Newbill, P., Upthegrove, T., Wyatt, A., & Jeon, M. (2022, April 21-23). *Child-robot musical theater for STEAM education* [Paper Presentation (4/21)]. Pre-Conference Workshop on Digital Media Cognitive Development of the Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society. Madison, WI, United States.

2021

46. **Choi, K.**, [U]Grados, M., & Bonawitz, E. (2021, April 7-9). *Child-led play supports adults' exploratory causal inferences* [Paper Presentation (4/9)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development. Virtual.

45. [G]Macias, C., & **Choi, K.** (2021, April 7-9). *Preschoolers' beliefs about different symbolic media: The role of socioeconomic backgrounds* [Paper Presentation (4/8)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development. Virtual.

44. **Choi, K.**, [G]Kim, J., [G]Shin, E., & Smith, C. L. (2021, April 7-9). *Maternal media beliefs moderate the relation between parenting stress and toddlers' screen use* [Poster Presentation (4/7)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development. Virtual.

43. Zettersten, M., **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H., & Saffran, J. (2021, April 7-9). *Children actively sample information in support of learning new words* [Paper Presentation (4/7)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development. Virtual.

2020

42. [G]Shin, E., **Choi, K.**, & Smith, C. L. (2020, November 1-2). *Why do parents use screen media with toddlers? The role of child temperament and parenting stress in early screen time* [Paper Presentation (11/2)]. The 23rd Occasional Temperament Conference, Blacksburg, VA. Virtual.

41. **Choi, K.**, [U]Grados, M., & Bonawitz, E. (2020, May 28-29). *Child-led play supports adults' exploratory causal inferences* [Paper Presentation Accepted, Conference Canceled due to COVID-19]. Special Topics Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development: Learning through Play and Imagination, St. Louis, MO, United States

2019

40. **Choi, K.**, [U]Grados, M., & Bonawitz, E. (2019, October 17-19). *Learning from children: Adults' exploratory causal inferences benefit from observing child-led explorations* [Poster Presentation (10/19)]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Louisville, KY, United States.

39. Zettersten, M., **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., & Saffran, J. (2019, October 17-19). *How does active sampling support learning new words?* [Poster Presentation (10/18)]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Louisville, KY, United States.

38. [G]Macias, C., [U]Shaban, F., Bonawitz, E., & **Choi, K.** (2019, October 17-19). *The effect of socioeconomic status on young children's perceptions about media devices* [Poster Presentation (10/17)]. Preconference Workshop on Digital Media and Cognitive Development at the Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Louisville, KY, United States.

37. **Choi, K.**, [U]Grados, M., & Bonawitz, E. (2019, July 24-27). *Observing child-led exploration improves parents' causal inferences* [Poster Presentation (7/27)]. Poster presented at the 41st Annual Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Montreal, Canada.

36. Rett, A., Bonawitz, E., **Choi, K.**, & Walker, C. (2019, July 24-27). *I never even considered that! Investing explanations for adults failures to learn conjunctive causal rules* [Poster Presentation (7/27)]. Annual Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Montreal, Canada.

35. Rett, A., Bonawitz, E., **Choi, K.**, & Walker, C. (2019, July 10-13). *When evidence alone is not enough: Facilitating the generation of unusual causal hypotheses* [Poster Presentation (7/13)]. Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology, San Diego, CA, United States.

34. **Choi, K.**, Lapidow, E., Austin, J., Shafto, P., & Bonawitz, E. (2019, March 21-23). *Preschoolers are more likely to direct learning content questions to adults than to other children (or selves) during spontaneous conversational acts* [Paper Presentation (3/23)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Baltimore, MD, United States.

33. **Choi, K.**, & Bonawitz, E. (2019, March 21-23). *Child-led play supports parents to make flexible and exploratory causal inferences* [Paper Presentation (3/23)]. The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Baltimore, MD, United States.

32. Baugh, C., Richert, R., Schlesinger, M., & **Choi, K.** (2019, March 21-23). *The role of perceived similarity in children's social learning* [Poster Presentation (3/22)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Baltimore, MD, United States.

2018

31. **Choi, K.**, Lapidow, E., Austin, J., Shafto, P., & Bonawitz, E. (2018, July 25-28). *Preschoolers are more likely to direct learning content questions to adults than to other children (or selves) during spontaneous conversational acts* [Paper Presentation (7/27)]. Annual Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Madison, WI, United States.

30. **Choi, K.**, & Bonawitz, E. (2018, July 25-28). *Adults can exploit children's exploration for their own learning: Child-led play supports adult causal conjunctive inferences* [Poster Presentation (7/25)]. Pre-Conference Workshop on Understanding Exploration-Exploration Trade Offs at The 40th Annual Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Madison, WI, United States.

2017

29. Kirkorian, H., **Choi, K.**, Yoo, S. & Etta, R. A. (2017, October 12-14). *Selective attention and learning from interactive and noninteractive video: An eye movement study* [Paper Presentation (10/14)]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Portland, OR, United States.

28. **Choi, K.**, Schlesinger, M. A., Grant, C., Puttre, H. J., Franchak, J. M., & Richert,

R. A. (2017, October 12-14). *Preschoolers use others' effort as a cue to attention and selective imitation* [Poster Presentation (10/13)]. Biennial meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Portland, OR, United States.

27. Jiang, M., **Choi, K.**, Raimer, C., Kirkorian, H. L., Tolkin, E., Sartin-Tarm, A., & Rosengren, K. S. (2017, October 12-14). *Children's action errors: A diary study in their natural environment* [Poster Presentation (10/13)]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Portland, OR, United States.

26. Lapidow, E., Bonawitz, E., Shafto, P., Austin, J., **Choi, K.**, Tariq, S., & Bell, C. (2017, October 12-14). *Preschoolers are more likely to direct questions to adults than to other children (or selves) during spontaneous conversational acts* [Poster Presentation (10/12)]. Cognitive Development Society Pre-Conference Workshop on Question Asking on Childhood, Portland, OR, United States.

25. Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, & Anderson, D. R. (2017, May 25-29). *Parents' active engagement mediates the impact of background TV on toddlers' play* [Paper Presentation (5/29)]. Annual Meeting of the International Communication Association, San Diego, CA, United States.

24. Etta, R. A, Kirkorian, H. L., & **Choi, K.**. (2017, May 25-29). *Preschoolers' learning from children's books: Effects of platform and interactivity* [Paper Presentation (5/29)]. Annual Meeting of the International Communication Association, San Diego, CA, United States.

23. **Choi, K.**, Schlesinger, M. A., Franchak, J. M., & Richert, R. A. (2017, May 25-29). *Character perceptions guide children's looking to and learning from on-screen characters* [Paper Presentation (5/28)]. Annual Meeting of the International Communication Association, San Diego, CA, United States.

22. Jiang, M., **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Travers, B. G., Rosengren, K. S., Millerhagen, J., Lee, C., & Haugstad, N. (2017, April 6-8). *Drawing across mediums: The impact of technology on the quality and production of drawings* [Poster Presentation (6/8)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Austin, TX, United States.

21. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., & Etta, R. A. (2017, April 6-8). *The effect of contextual variability on the generalization of category labels between symbolic mediums* [Poster Presentation (6/7)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Austin, TX, United States.

20. Etta, R. A, Kirkorian, H. L., & **Choi, K.**. (2017, April 6-8). *Preschoolers' learning from children's books: Effects of platform and interactivity* [Poster Presentation (6/7)]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Austin, TX, United States.

2016

19. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Pempek, T. A., & Etta, R. A. (2016, October). *On-screen or off-screen? The role of retrieval contexts and working memory in toddlers' object retrieval using touch screens* [Flash Talk Presentation]. Special Topics Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Irvine, CA, United States.

18. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Pempek, T. A., & Etta, R. A. (2016, May). *Toddlers' object retrieval using touchscreens: The role of working memory skills* [Paper Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the International Congress of Infant Studies, New

Orleans, LA, United States.

17. Jiang, M. J., **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Travers, B. G., Rosengren, K. S., Jobin, P., Pavalko, P., Matoba, M. & Tolkin, E. (2016, May). *Drawing across media: The impact of technology on the quality of drawings* [Poster Presentation]. Annual Meeting of the Association for Psychological Science, Chicago, IL, United States.

2015

16. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Pempek, T. A., Schroeder, E. L, & Etta, R. A. (2015, October). *The impact of contextual differences on toddlers' object retrieval using touchscreens* [Poster Presentation]. Digital Media & Developing Minds Conference, National Academies of Sciences Sackler Colloquia, Irvine, CA, United States.
15. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Pempek, T. A., Schroeder, E. L, & Etta, R. A. (2015, October). *The impact of contextual differences on toddlers' object retrieval using touchscreens* [Poster Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Columbus, OH, United States.
14. Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, Pempek, T. A., Schroeder, E. L., & Etta, R. A. (2015, May). *Toddlers' learning from interactive vs. non-interactive mediated experiences using touchscreens* [Paper Presentation]. Annual Meeting of the International Communication Association, San Juan, PR, United States.
13. Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, Schroeder, E., Pempek, T. A., & Etta, R. A. (2015, May). *Toddlers' learning from video: The role of cognitive-control skills* [Paper Presentation]. Annual Meeting of the International Communication Association, San Juan, PR, United States.
12. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Pempek, T. A., & Schroeder, E. L. (2015, March). *Toddlers' object retrieval using touchscreens: The role of working memory skills* [Paper Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development in Philadelphia, PA, United States.
11. Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, Schroeder, E. L., & Etta, R. A. (2015, March). *Object retrieval using interactive video: The role of visual selection in learning from screens* [Paper Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development in Philadelphia, PA, United States.

2014

10. Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, Pempek, T. A., & Schroeder, E. L. (2014, June). *Toddlers' learning from interactive and non-interactive video on touchscreens* [Poster Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the International Society on Infant Studies in Berlin, Germany.
9. **Choi, K.**, Schroeder, E. L., & Kirkorian, H. L. (2014, May). *Toddlers' learning from touchscreens: Object retrieval using interactive vs. non-interactive video* [Paper Presentation]. Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL, United States.

2013

8. **Choi, K.**, & Kirkorian, H. L. (2013, November). *Attention, comprehension, and learning from video: Evidence from eye movement studies* [Poster Presentation]. Workshop on Learning to Attend, Attending to Learn: Neurological, behavioral, and computational perspectives, San Diego, CA, United States.
7. Kirkorian, H. L., & **Choi, K.** (2013, October). *Age differences in top-down control of visual attention during video viewing* [Paper Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the

Cognitive Development Society, Memphis, TN, United States.

6. Vigna, A., **Choi, K.**, Clarkson, A., Hickey, E., Burgess-Hull, A., Burnson, C., Runion, H., Sheche, J., & Pinela, C. (2013, October). *The development, assessment, and impact of a low-cost mindfulness meditation outreach program for a university campus community* [Poster Presentation]. Conference for Contemplative Practices to Promote Child and Family Well-Being, Madison, WI, United States.
5. **Choi, K.**, & Kirkorian, H. L. (2013, April). *Object retrieval using contingent vs. non-contingent video on touchscreens* [Poster Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society of Research in Child Development, Seattle, WA, United States.
4. **Choi, K.**, Kirkorian, H. L., Hanson, K. G., & Anderson, D. R. (2013, April). *The impact of background television and parent-child interaction on young children's toy play* [Poster Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society of Research in Child Development, Seattle, WA, United States.
3. Kirkorian, H. L., **Choi, K.**, & Pempek, T. A. (2013, April). *Toddlers' word-learning from contingent vs. non-contingent video on touchscreens* [Paper Presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society of Research in Child Development, Seattle, WA, United States.

2012

2. Kirkorian, H., & **Choi, K.** (2012, June). *Eye-tracking techniques for studying age differences in online processing of video* [Poster Presentation]. Workshop on Eye Tracking Methodology in Child and Infant Research, Minneapolis, MN, United States.
1. Burgess-Hull, A., Burnson, C., **Choi, K.**, Hickey, E., Pinela, C., Runion, H., Samuelson, A., Sheche, J., & Vigna, A. (2012, April). *The development, assessment, and impact of a mindfulness meditation outreach program* [Poster Presentation]. International Symposia of Contemplative Studies, Denver, CO, United States.

Invited Intramural Seminars

2026

- **Choi, K.** (2026, October 30). *Young children's development in a digital world: From video to AI.* Center for Human-Computer Interaction (CHCI) Headliner Seminar Series, Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA. (Scheduled)
- **Choi, K.** , [G]Chen, J., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., [G]Gürdal, M. S., [G]Pyon, J., & [P]Macias, C. (2026, October 23). *Research in the Cognitive Developmental Science Lab.* Developmental Area Lunch & Learn, Department of Psychology, Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA. (Scheduled)

2025

- **Choi, K.** (2025, March 5). *Mentoring undergraduate students in research.* Panel Discussion at the VT Faculty Mentoring Forum, Blacksburg, VA.
- **Choi, K.**, Hornburg, C. B., Lee, S. W., [G]Ozcan, M. S., [G]Yu, S., [G]Chen, J., [G]Gürdal, M. S., [G]Colbert, M., [G]Diaz, D., & [G]Karunaratna, S. (2025, February 28). *Reimagining early learning through AI-enhanced parent-child playful joint reading.* VT ICAT Playdate, Blacksburg, VA.

2024
- **Choi, K.** (2024, October 4). *Technology and cognitive development.* VT Psychology Lunch and Learn Meeting, Blacksburg, VA.
- **Choi, K.** (2024, September 27). *AI and Young Children.* Science, Technology, and Society at the VT Seminar Series: Youth Wellbeing and Digital Technology Roundtable, Blacksburg, VA.

2023
- **Choi, K.** (2023, April 3). *Children's learning from contemporary and emerging interactive technologies.* Biological Systems Engineering Seminar, Blacksburg, VA.

2022
- **Choi, K.** (2023, Dec 22). *Children and technology research.* Learning Lunch Series, The Asian Cultural Engagement Center, Virginia Tech, VA.
- **Choi, K.** (2022, May 2). *Act, Dance, Sing, and Learn with social robots: Child-robot musical theater for informal STEAM education.* Center for Humanities, Virginia Tech, VA. Virtual.

2021
- **Choi, K.** (2021, March 3). *How do we perceive and learn from robots?* Center for Humanities, Virginia Tech, VA. Virtual.

2020
- **Choi, K.** (2020, February 19). *Children's active learning with technology.* Center for Humanities, Virginia Tech, VA. Virtual.

2017
- **Choi, K.** (2017, October). *Young children's transfer of learning from interactive and noninteractive media*, Talk presented at Cognitive Brain and Behavior Brownbag, Department of Psychology, Rutgers University - Newark.

2013
- **Choi, K.** (2013, May). *The influence of media on children's development*, Talk presented at Scholarly SoHE, School of Human Ecology, UW-Madison.
- **Choi, K.** (2013, May). *Object retrieval using contingent vs. non-contingent video on touchscreens*, Poster presented at the Wisconsin Alumni Research Foundation Discovery Challenge, UW-Madison.
- **Choi, K.** (2013, April). *The role of individual differences in cognitive skills in children's learning through educational media*, Poster presented at the School of Human Ecology Student Poster & Project Exhibition, UW-Madison.
- **Choi, K.** (2013, February). *The impact of background television and parent-child interaction on young children's toy play*, Talk presented at Professional Development Seminar in Human Development & Family Studies, UW-Madison.

2012
- **Choi, K.** (2012, May). *Children's learning from touchscreens: Object retrieval using interactive vs. non-interactive Video*, Poster presented at the Wisconsin Alumni Research Foundation Discovery Challenge, UW-Madison.
- **Choi, K.** (2012, April). *Touchscreens and early childhood mathematics*, Poster presented at the School of Human Ecology Student Poster & Project Exhibition, UW-Madison.
- **Choi, K.** (2012, April). *NSF research grant proposal - Children's learning from touchscreens: Object retrieval using interactive vs. non-interactive video*, Talk presented at Professional Development Seminar in Human Development & Family Studies, UW-Madison.

TEACHING

Lead Instructor

Fall 2026

- HD 4994 (CRN: 86598) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  10 undergraduate students (+ 2 volunteers)

Spring 2026

- HD 1004 (CRN: 16341) - Childhood and Adolescence
  79 undergraduate students
- HD 3024 (CRN: 16357) - Community Analytics
  40 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 16383) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  11 undergraduate students (+ 5 volunteers)
- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate student (1 credit hour)

Fall 2025

- HD 5514 & HD5974 - Research Methods (CRN: 86431) + Lab (CRN: 86435)
  7 graduate students
- HD 1004 (CRN: 86386) - Childhood and Adolescence
  121 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 86424) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  10 undergraduate students
- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate student (1 credit hour)

Spring 2025

- HD 1004 (CRN: 16331) - Childhood and Adolescence
  80 undergraduate students
- HD 3024 (CRN: 16347) - Community Analytics
  60 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 16367) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  9 undergraduate students
- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate student (2 credit hours)

Fall 2024

- HD 5514 & HD5974 - Research Methods (CRN: 86195) + Lab (CRN: 86200)
  8 graduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 86187) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  7 undergraduate students
- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate student (1 credit hour)

Spring 2024

- HD 1004 (CRN: 16271) - Childhood and Adolescence
  74 undergraduate students
- HD 1004 (CRN: 16275) - Childhood and Adolescence
  79 undergraduate students (Online)
- HD 4994 (CRN: 16318) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  8 undergraduate students

- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate students (1 credit hour)

Fall 2023
- HD 1004 (CRN: 86113) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  119 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 86144) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  7 undergraduate students, 1 volunteer
- HD 5514 & HD5974 - Research Methods (CRN: 86157) + Lab (CRN: 86161)
  8 graduate students

Spring 2023
- HD 1004 (CRN: 16201) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  71 undergraduate students
- HD 1004 (CRN: 21304) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  74 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 16255) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  9 undergraduate students, 2 volunteers

Fall 2022
- HD 1004 (CRN: 85980) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  117 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 86020) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  11 undergraduate students, 3 volunteers
- HD 5514 & HD5974 - Research Methods (CRN: 86028) + Lab (CRN: 86038)
  8 graduate students

Spring 2022
- HD 1004 (CRN: 10637) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  79 undergraduate students
- HD 1004 (CRN: 10638) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  77 undergraduate students (Virtual)
- HD 4994 (CRN: 16084) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  6 undergraduate students, 2 volunteers
- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate students (1 credit hour)

Fall 2021
- HD 1004 (CRN: 85680) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  77 undergraduate students (Virtual)
- HD 4994 (CRN: 92576) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  5 undergraduate students, 3 volunteers
- HD 5514 & HD 5974 - Research Methods (CRN: 85747) + Lab (CRN: 93212)
  9 graduate students
- HD 5964 - TS: HD Research Team
  1 graduate students (1 credit hour)

Spring 2021
- HD 4994 (CRN: 15950) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  5 undergraduate students, 5 volunteers

Fall 2020
- HD 1004 (CRN: 85528) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  74 undergraduate students (Virtual)
- HD 4994 (CRN: 92606) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  3 undergraduate students, 7 volunteers

Spring 2020
- HD 1004 (CRN: 15429) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  74 undergraduate students
- HD 3014 (CRN: 19961) - Research Methods in Human Development
  47 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 21521) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  10 undergraduate students, 5 volunteers

Fall 2019
- HD 1004 (CRN: 85117) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  121 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 91019, 91544) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  10 undergraduate students, 4 volunteers
- HD 5514 (CRN: 85161) - Research Methods
  8 graduate students

Spring 2019
- HD 1004 (CRN: 15080) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  57 undergraduate students
- HD 4994 (CRN: 19013) - Undergraduate Research: Children & Technology
  2 undergraduate students, 1 volunteer

Fall 2018
- HD 1004 (CRN: 84910) - Human Development I: Conception to Adolescence
  77 undergraduate students (Virtual)

Research Supervisor

Fall 2017 - Spring 2018
- PSYC 21:830:491 - Section 19: Research in Psychology
  Rutgers University - Newark (Instructor: Dr. Elizabeth Bonawitz)
  Supervised 2-4 undergraduate research assistants per semester

Fall 2016 - Spring 2017
- PSYC 182E - 001: Laboratory in Psychology (Developmental)
  University of California, Riverside (Instructor: Dr. Rebekah Richert)
  Supervised 3-9 undergraduate research assistants per quarter

Fall 2012 - Spring 2016
- HDFS 592: Research Experience in HDFS
  University of Wisconsin-Madison (Instructor: Dr. Heather Kirkorian)
  Supervised 3-8 undergraduate students per semester

Guest Instructor [G]Graduate student mentee

Spring 2025
- HD 6004: Professional Development Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Paul Springer)
  Cover Letters
  Presented with Wesche, R.

Spring 2025
- HD 5654: Grant Development & Administration in Human Development
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Pamela B. Teaster)
  Selecting expertise for the grant team: Principal investigators, c0-investigators, and staff?
  Presented with Hornburg, C.

Spring 2024
- HD 6004: Professional Development Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Benjamin Katz)
  Academic CV
  Presented with Wesche, R.

Fall 2022
- EDEC 445: Administration of Programs for Young Children
  Radford University (Instructor: Dr. Boyoung Park)
  Children's learning from digital media technology in early childhood
  Presented with [G]Kim, J. and [G]Yu, S.

Spring 2022
- EDEC 445: Administration of Programs for Young Children
  Radford University (Instructor: Dr. Boyoung Park)
  Children's learning from digital media technology in early childhood

Spring 2021
- HD 5224: Child Development in the Family Context
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Caroline Hornburg)
  Cognitive Development: Attention, Media/Technology
- HDFS Graduate Student Anti-Racism Book Club
  Virginia Tech (Organizer: Jessica Resor)
  White Logic, White Methods, Part VI: The Practice of Racial Research and Conclusion

Fall 2020
- HD 6004: Prof Development Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Cynthia Smith)
  Child and adolescent development article discussion

Spring 2020
- HD 6004: Prof Development Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Cynthia Smith)
  Types of Conference Presentations
- HD 1004: Human Development I
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Kee Jeong Kim)
  Ethology and Ecology

Fall 2019
- Comm 5494: Media, Tech, Society: Media and Youth
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Adrienne Ivory)
  Children's learning from non-interactive and interactive media
- HD 5974: Teaching Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Ms. Victoria Lael)
  Faculty panel on perspectives on teaching for graduate student instructors of record

Spring 2019
- HD 6004: Prof Development Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Cynthia Smith)
  Job searching in academia and submitting articles to journals

Fall 2018
- HD 6004: Prof Development Seminar
  Virginia Tech (Instructor: Dr. Cynthia Smith)
  Prosem hot topic: Digital media and child and adolescence development

Fall 2015
- HDFS 425: Research Methods in Human Development and Family Studies
  University of Wisconsin-Madison (Instructor: Dr. Janean Dilworth-Bart)
  Experimental designs in research
- HDFS 469: Family and Community Influences on the Young Child
  University of Wisconsin-Madison (Instructor: Ms. Lauren Lewis)
  The influence of background TV on children's play and parent-child interaction
- HDFS 474: Racial Ethnic Families in U.S
  University of Wisconsin-Madison (Instructor: Dr. Lynet Uttal)
  The influence of media on children's racial attitude and behaviors
- HDFS 616: Mass Media and Youth
  University of Wisconsin-Madison (Instructor: Dr. Heather Kirkorian)
  Transfer of learning and Interactive Media
- HDFS 474: Racial Ethnic Families in U.S. (002)
  University of Wisconsin-Madison (Instructor: Ms. Lauren Lewis)
  Children, Race, Ethnicity, and Media

MENTORSHIP

Dissertation Supervision (Chair) [4] 3 Chair, 1 Co-Chair

2024 - Present
- Jing Chen (in progress; Chair)
  - Dissertation Topic: *Understanding the relations between video viewing and creativity in early childhood*

2024 - Present
- Mahmut Sami Gürdal (in progress; Co-Chair)
  - Dissertation Topic: *Understanding preschoolers' problematic media use through temperamental reactivity and regulation with a new digital frustration task*

2022 - 2025
- Shuqi Yu, Ph.D. in Human Development
  (completed in Summer 2025)
  - Dissertation: *TParenting stress, social support, and affiliate stigma among Asian and White parents of children with autism in the United States*

2020 - 2024
- Jisun Kim, Ph.D. in Human Development
  (completed in Summer 2024)
  - Dissertation: *Preschoolers' mathematical language ;earning during book reading with an AI voice agent*

Master's Thesis Supervision (Chair) [2] 2 Co-Chair

2022 - 2024 • Sulakna Karunaratna, M.S. in Computer Science
(completed Fall 2024; Co-Chair)
- Thesis: *When less can be more: Evaluating the impact of animated and interactive demonstrations in voice-assisted counting games for young children*

2022 - 2024 • Mahmut Sami Gürdal, M.S. in Human Development
(completed Spring 2024; Co-Chair)
- Thesis: *Emotion regulation and screen use among parents of toddlers: A moderating role of parental personality*

Visiting Graduate Scholar [1] 1 Faculty Sponsor

2024 - 2025 • Meryem Şeyda Özcan, Ph.D. Candidate in Developmental Psychology at Koç University (in progress; Faculty Sponsor)
- Project: *Understanding the role of digital media on young children's executive functions*

Postdoctoral Fellow [2] 1 Faculty Sponsor, 1 Faculty Co-Sponsor

2025 - Present • Meryem Şeyda Özcan, Virginia Tech Presidential Postdoctoral Fellow (in progress; Faculty Sponsor)
- Project: *Digital media and children's cognitive development*

2024 - Present • Carla Macias, National Science Foundation Postdoctoral Fellow (in progress; Faculty Co-Sponsor)
- Project: *STEMEdIPRF: Looking beyond screen time: Exploring the relationship between diverse media experience, educational expectations, and learning in children*
- Carla Macias (PI); Kimele Persaud (Faculty Primary Sponsor), Koeun Choi (Faculty Co-Sponsor)

Temporary Advisee at Virginia Tech [1] 1 Temporary Advisor

2021 - 2022 • Madelyn Toman, M.S./Ph.D. Student

Committee Member [15] 5 MS, 10 PhD

2026 - Present • Aruzhan Zhaksylyk, Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Science

2026 - Present • Isabela de la Rosa, Ph.D. in Psychology

2025 - 2026 • Isabela de la Rosa, M.S. in Psychology (completed in Spring 2026)

2025 • Meryem Şeyda Özcan, Ph.D. in Psychology, Koç University (completed in Summer 2025)

2023 - 2026 • Marrium Mansoor, Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Summer 2025)

2023 - 2026 • Maegan Reinhardt, Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Spring 2026)

2023 - 2025 • Elayna Seago, Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Summer 2025)

2023 - 2024 • Daniel Vargas-Diaz, M.S. in Computer Science (completed in Spring 2024)

2021 - 2023 • Marrium Mansoor, M.S. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Spring 2023)
• Caroline Taylor, Ph.D. in Psychology (completed in Spring 2023)

2020 - 2023 • Candy Beers, Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Spring 2023)

2019 - 2023 • Diana Devine, Ph.D. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Fall 2023)

2019 - 2021 • Jessica Resor, Ph.D., Human Development and Family Science (completed in Fall 2021)
• Shuqi Yu, M.S. in Human Development and Family Science (completed in Spring 2021)
• Caroline Taylor, M.S., Psychology (completed in Spring 2021)

Graduate Research Assistants at Virginia Tech [7] 2 MS, 5 PhD

2024 - • Jing Chen (PhD in progress)

2023 Su - • Mahmut Sami Gürdal (PhD in progress)

2022 - 2023 • Maddie Toman (PhD in progress)

2021 - 2025 • Shuqi Yu
- Currently a Postdoctoral Researcher in the Department of Psychology and Neuroscience at Dalhousie University, Canada

2020 - 2024 • Jisun Kim
- Currently a Postdoctoral Researcher in the Department of Human Development and Family Science at Purdue University

2019 - 2020 • Jessica Resor
- Currently an IRB coordinator, the Office or Research at the University of Cincinnati

2018 - 2020 • Eunkyung Lucy Shin
- Hired as a Postdoctoral Research Associate at the Fralin Biomedical Research Institute at the Virginia Tech Carilion School of Medicine (VTC)
- Currently an Assistant Research Professor in the Department of Psychology at Penn State University

Graduate Teaching Assistants at Virginia Tech [8]

Fall 2025 • Sezercan Ucar (HD 5514)
• Mahmut Sami Gürdal (HD 1004)

Fall 2024 • Sezercan Ucar (HD 5514)

Fall 2023	• Maegan Reinhardt (HD 1004), Jisun Kim (HD 5514)
Fall 2022	• Shuqi Yu (HD 1004), Jisun Kim (HD 5514)
Fall 2021	• Diana Devine (HD 5514)
Fall 2020	• Candy Beers (HD 1004)
Fall 2019	• Shawnice Johnson (HD 1004)

Undergraduate Research Assistants at Virginia Tech [46]

F27-Present	• Trace Huang, Logan Henry, Joelle Lee, Mounika Neelisetty
S26-Present	• Sydney Street, Daniela McGhie, Sai Abhishikth Nallani, Isabella Bozan, Ana Mellone
S26	• Ana Mellone
F25-Present	• Grace Ambrosio, Leanne Bell, Josie Vernon, Jack Quan, Owen Brydges, Raaga Puvvadi
S25-Present	• Allison Brant, Izabella Faza
S25	• Rachael Mannix
F24-Present	• Maya Thomas, Kathryn Seiple
F24-SP25	• Nithya Ramani, Erin Wade
F24	• Herminio Giron
Sp24-Present	• Hailey Annibell
Sp24	• Junwoo Seo, Hailey Annibell, Monika Khadka
F23 - Sp24	• Ilan Litvak, Rahul Bhamidipati, Bailey Vaughn, Alethia Holstein, Alia Konold
F23	• Christine Lolavar, Ahmed (Belal) Qazizada
Spr23	• Lauren Meier
F22 - F23	• Maggie Ashley
F22 - Sp23	• Sebastian Ballesteros, Angel Appiadu-Manu, Alina Tseng, Maggie Ashley, Zainab Shamim, Yilin Liu
F22	• Sraavya Gudavalli, Richard Martinez
Sp22 - F22	• Laura Zhang Zhang, Ursilia Beckles, Luke Janoschka
Spring 2022	• Ava Morris, Julia Place
F21 - Sp23	• Yullie Kwak
F21	• Naheda Nassan
F21 - Sp23	• Jordan Teel
Sp21 - F23	• Martha Drapac
F19 - Sp22	• Breanne De Vera
F19 - F21	• Ava Bir, Michelle Tran, Taylor Covington
F19 - Sp21	• Anvitha Metpally, Eman Ayaz
Sp20 - F21	• Molly Simek, Caroline Kammer
F19 - F20	• Ally Copeland
F19 - S20	• Eva Catherine Grumbine, Valerie Salmon
F19 - Sp20	• Rhea Bhatia, Sara Belay
Sp19 - Sp21	• Bethany Grocock, Katie Johnson
Su19	• Rachel Metts

Sp19	• Ashleigh Bedwell

Undergraduate Field Study at Virginia Tech [6]

FA25	• Grace Ambrosio
Sp25	• Rachael Mannix
F23 - Sp24	• Alethia Holstein
F22 - Sp23	• Sebastian Ballesteros
F23	• Maggie Ashley
Su21-F21	• Julia Ricci

Undergraduate Honors Credit at Virginia Tech [1]

Fall 2020	• Martha Drapac

Undergraduate Advising at Virginia Tech at Virginia Tech

Spring 2021 - Fall 2023	• Advising 10-14 students of Childhood Pre-Education (CPED) or Human Development (HD) Major per semester

EDITORIAL ACTIVITIES

Associate Editor [1]

2024 - 2025	• Korean Journal of Child Studies

Editorial Board [7]

2023 -	• Journal of Experimental Child Psychology
2023	• Korean Journal of Human Development
2023	• Korean Journal for Infant Mental Health
2022 -	• Journal of Applied Developmental Psychology
2022	• Frontiers in Psychology
2021 -	• Media Psychology
2019	• Korean Journal of the Society for Cognitive Enhancement and Intervention

Ad-Hoc Journal Reviewer

- BMC Psychology
- British Journal of Developmental Psychology
- British Journal of Educational Technology
- Child Development
- Computers and Education
- Developmental Science
- Early Education and Development
- Education Sciences
- Educational Psychology
- European Journal of Psychology of Education
- Family Relations
- Frontiers in Psychology
- Human Behavior and Emerging Technologies
- Infancy
- Infant Behavior and Development
- Infant and Child Development
- International Journal of Behavioral Development
- International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction
- International Journal of Human-Computer Studies
- Journal of Applied Developmental Psychology
- Journal of Children and Media
- Journal of Cognition and Development
- Journal of Experimental Child Psychology
- Journal of Family Theory & Review
- Korean Journal of Cognitive Enhancement and Intervention
- Media Psychology
- PLOS ONE
- Scientific Reports

Conference Submission Reviewer [12] [G]Graduate student mentee

2026
- Reviewer for the 2027 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development as a Mentor (Mentee: [P]Meryem Şeyda Özcan)
- Reviewer for the 2026 Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) Conference on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)

2025
- Reviewer for the 2025 Cognitive Science Society Conference (CogSci)

2023
- Reviewer for the 2024 Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)

2022
- Reviewer for the 2023 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development as a Mentor (Mentee: [G]Shuqi Yu)

2021
- Reviewer for the 2022 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research on Adolescence as a Mentor (Mentees: [G]Jisun Kim, [G]Shuqi Yu)

- Reviewer for the 2021 Annual American Psychological Association (APA) Conference on Technology, Mind, and Society

2020
- Reviewer for the 2021 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development as a Mentor (Mentee: [G]Jisun Kim)

2019
- Reviewer for the 2020 Special Topics Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Learning through Play and Imagination

2018
- Reviewer for the 2019 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development

2017
- Reviewer for the 2018 Technology, Mind and Society Conference of the American Psychological Association

2016
- Reviewer for Doctoral Consortium at the 2016 Special Topics Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development
- Student Reviewer for the 2016 Special Topics Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Technology and Media in Children's Development (Mentor: Dr. Kaveri Subrahmanyam)

2012
- Student Reviewer for the 2013 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Panel 26: Contexts of Child Development: Family, Neighborhood, Child Care, Media, & Religious Institutions (Mentor: Dr. Heather Kirkorian)

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Grant Proposal Reviews [4]

2026
- Ad Hoc Reviewer, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (SSHRC) Insight Grants

2025
- Ad Hoc Reviewer, The Impact of Digital Technology on the Brain, Mind, and Behaviour of Young People, Huo Family Foundation

2024
- Review Panel, National Science Foundation, Division of Research on Learning in Formal and Informal Settings

2023
- Ad Hoc Reviewer, National Science Foundation, Division of Developmental Science

Conference Symposium Organizer and Chair [10]

2026
- Co-Organizer (Lauren Girouard, Elizabeth Goldman, Anna-Elisabeth Baumann, Meryem Şeyda Özcan, Carla Macias, & **Choi, K.**), *Children and technology: Emerging scholars, emerging methods, emerging directions.* Cognitive Development Society Pre-Conference Workshop, Montreal, Canada.

2023
- Chair, *The impact of socially interactive technologies on parent-child interactions and young children's learning.* Symposium presented at the biennial meeting of Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.

2022
- Co-Organizer (**Choi, K.**, & Kirkorian, H.L), *Digital media and cognitive development.* Cognitive Development Society Pre-conference Workshop, Madison, WI.
- Chair, *Emerging technologies and cognitive development.* Symposium presented at the Cognitive Development Society Pre-conference Workshop, Madison, WI.
- Co-Organizer (Bhatti, N., Kelliher, A., Hiniker A., **Choi, K.**, Shahid, S., Ammari, T., Xu, Y., Murad, C., & Michelson, R.), *Technology for children at home: Exploring ways to support caregivers with screen and voice based technology.* Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) International Conference on Supporting Group Work (GROUP) Workshop, Virtual

2020
- Chair, *Temperament and Technology.* Symposium presented at the Occasional Temperament Conference, Blacksburg, VA.

2019
- Co-Organizer (Kirkorian, H.L., Richert, R. R., & Choi, K), *Digital media and cognitive development.* Cognitive Development Society Pre-conference Workshop, Louisville, KY.
- Chair, *Direct and indirect learning from digital media.* Symposium Presented at the Cognitive Development Society Pre-conference Workshop, Louisville, KY.

2017
- Co-Organizer (Richert, R. R., Kirkorian, H.L., & Choi, K), *Digital media and cognitive development.* Cognitive Development Society Pre-conference Workshop, Portland, OR.

2016
- Chair, *Understanding children's learning from interactive touchscreens.* Symposium presented at the Special Topics Meeting on Technology and Media in Children's Development of the Society for Research in Child Development, Irvine, CA.

Academic Community [5]

2021 - Present
- Regional Representative (Southeast) for the Korean American Early Childhood Researchers Association (KAECRA)

2021
- Mentor for the Asian Caucus Mentoring session at the 2021 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development

2020 - Present
- Member of the Board of Directors, Korean Association of Child Studies

2019 - Present
- Member of the Board of Directors, Korean Psychological Association, Developmental Psychology Division

2013 - 2017
- Student representative to the Interdisciplinary Committee on the Student and Early Career Council (SECC) in Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)

SERVICE TO THE UNIVERSITY

Virginia Tech [2]

2021 - 2022
- Advisory Board Member, The Office of Undergraduate Research, Virginia Tech

2018 - 2023 • Department Representative, College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences Library Committee, Virginia Tech

Department of Human Development and Family Science at Virginia Tech [7]

2026 • Faculty Search Committee Member - Faculty Search Committee (HDFS; Adaptive Brain and Behavior), Virginia Tech

2025 • HDFS Department Head Review Committee, Virginia Tech

2023 - Present • Departmental Awards Committee (HDFS), Virginia Tech

2022 - 2023 • Faculty Search Committee Member - Department Head Search Committee (HDFS), Virginia Tech

2021 - Present • Child and Adolescent Development Area Coordinator, Virginia Tech

2019 - 2020 • Faculty Search Committee Member - Faculty Search Committee (HDFS; Marriage and Family Therapy), Virginia Tech

2018 - 2019 • Faculty Search Committee Member (Diversity Advocate) - Faculty Search Committee (HDFS; Child and Adolescent Development), Virginia Tech

SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY

Invited Community Workshops and Presentations [7]

2026
- **Choi, K.** (2026, October 5). *Growing up digital: Finding the right balance in early learning* [Panelist]. 2026 Virginia Education Summit, Richmond, VA.
- **Choi, K.**, [G]Chen, J., [P]Özcan, M. Ş., & [G]Gürdal, M. S. (2026, October 1). *Digital well-being for kids.* [Co-Presentation] Hokie Wellness for Employees, Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA.
- **Choi, K.** (2026, March 19). *Generation AI: Youth mental health and well-being in a digital world* [Participant], Congressional Briefing and Capitol Hill Day, Washington, DC.

2025
- **Choi, K.** (2025, April 9). *Strategies to help children's healthy screen use.* Virginia Tech Early Childhood Education Initiative Lunch & Learn, Virtual.

2024
- **Choi, K.** (2024, July 17). *The impacts of digital technology on children's health.* Virginia Joint Commission on Healthcare, Richmond, VA.
- **Choi, K.** (2024, February 5). *Young children and technology.* New River Valley (NRV) Virginia Association for the Education of Young Children (VAEYC) Meeting, Pulaski, VA.

2020
- **Choi, K.** (2020). *Screen time for children: Guidance for parents.* Virginia Tech Parent Teacher Association Meeting, Blacksburg, VA.

2016
- **Choi, K.** (2016). *Children and screens: New media and new guidance for parents.* UW Extension Family Living Program Webcast, Madison, WI. [Co-presentation]

2015
- **Choi, K.** (2015). *The impact of technology on learning and development.* Wisconsin Early Childhood Association Annual Meeting, Madison, WI.

2014 • **Choi, K.** (2014). *Helping young children learn and grow seminar.* Wisconsin 4-H & Youth Conference, Madison, WI.

Media Contributions

2025 • Experts: Why landlines make sense for parents in digital age, *VT News.*

2025 • Responsible robot and AI literacy. Embodied informal learning on ethical robotics and AI through a creative afterschool program, *VT News.*

2025 • Technology Meets Early Learning *VT News & College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences digital magazine, ECHO.*

2023 • Screen time and young children with Koeun Choi, *Curious Conversation Podcast.*

2022 • Children befriend robots in playful after-school research program, *VT News.*

2020 • School's back, now what? How to navigate education on and offline during the global pandemic. Experts tips for parents newsletter on going back to school, *Children and Screens.*

Outreach Projects [26] [G]Graduate student mentee

2025 • *AI and robots for young children's learning.* Exhibit at the Virgina Tech Science Festival, Blacksburg, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Mahmut Sami Gürdal
• *AI and robots for young children's Learning.* Exhibit at Roanoke STEAM Day, Roanoke, VA. Organizer
• *Math games and robots.* Exhibit at Wonder Universe STEM Saturday, Christiansburg, VA. Collaborator (Organizer: Caroline Hornburg)
• *Virginia Tech Developmental Science Network.* Booth at Back to School Night, Christiansburg, VA. Collaborator (Organizer: Caroline Hornburg)
• *Let's take turns in playful reading with AI voices!* Exhibit at the ICAT Creativity and Innovation Day, Blacksburg, VA. Organizer

2024 • *Let's read together! Children's storybook reading with conversational AI.* Exhibit at the ICAT Creativity and Innovation Day, Blacksburg, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Jisun Kim
• *Research on storytelling with conversational AI and social robots.* Hands-on Booth at the Hokie for a Day Event, Blacksburg, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Meryem Şeyda Özcan
• *Research on conversational AI agents.* Hands-on Booth at the Belview Elementary STEM Family Night, Radford, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Mahmut Sami Gürdal
• *Let's play with robot friends!* Hands-on Activities for the Week of the Young Child at the Child Development Center for Learning and Research (CDCLR), Blacksburg, VA. Organizer
• *Math games and robots.* Hands-on Booth at Virginia Tech YMCA Healthy Kids Day Outreach. Collaborator (Organizer: Caroline Hornburg)

2023

- *Preschoolers' mathematical language learning during book reading with an AI smart speaker.* Poster Presentation and Demonstration at the Virginia Association for the Education of Young Children (VAEYC) Teacher Conference, Blacksburg, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Jisun Kim.
- *Child-robot theater afterschool program.* 11-Week Afterschool Program at the Eastern Montgomery Elementary School, Elliston, VA. Collaborator (Organizer: Myounghoon Jeon)
- *Math masterminds.* Exhibit at the Hokie for a Day Expo, Blacksburg, VA. Collaborator (Organizer: Caroline Hornburg).
- *Conversational AI and social robots for storytelling.* Exhibit at the Virginia Tech Science Festival, Blacksburg, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Shuqi Yu
- *Conversational AI for children's learning.* Demonstration at the Virginia Tech Humanities Week, Blacksburg, VA. Faculty Mentor supporting [G]Jisun Kim
- *Robotics summer camp.* Summer Camp at the Valley Interfaith Child Care Center, Blacksburg, VA. Organizer
- *Hi robot friends!* Hands-on Activities for the Week of the Young Child at the Child Development Center for Learning and Research (CDCLR), Blacksburg, VA. Organizer
- *Child-robot theater preschool program.* 7-Week Afterschool Program at the Valley Interfaith Child Care Center, Blacksburg, VA. Organizer

2022

- *Child-robot theater afterschool program.* 13-Week Afterschool Program at the Eastern Montgomery Elementary School, Elliston, VA. Collaborator (Organizer: Myounghoon Jeon)
- *Hang out with robots.* Exhibit at the Virginia Tech Science Festival, Blacksburg, VA. Collaborator (Organizer: [G]Jia Dong)
- *Child-robot theater preschool program.* 7-Week Afterschool Program at the Child Development Center for Learning and Research, Blacksburg, VA. Organizer
- *Robot musical theater for STEAM.* Exhibit at the ICAT Creativity + Innovation Day, Blacksburg, VA. Co-Organizer (Organizer: [G]Jia Dong)
- *Robot musical theater.* Performance and Presentation at the 2022 Ut Prosim Seminar, Blacksburg, VA. Co-Organizer (Organizer: Myounghoon Jeon)
- *Robot musical theater.* Presentation at the ICAT Playdate, Blacksburg, VA. Co-Organizer (Organizer: [G]Jia Dong)

2021

- *Child-Robot theater afterschool program.* 13-Week Afterschool Program at the Eastern Montgomery Elementary School, Elliston, VA. Collaborator
- *Climate change: Your voice is important (robot musical theater).* Performance at the Virginia Tech Science Festival, Blacksburg, VA. Co-Organizer (Organizer: [G]Yeaji Lee)
- *Look, think, and play: Mobile eye tracking and math games.* Eye-tracking technol-

ogy Zoom outreach meetup sessions at the Virginia Tech Science Festival (Virtual), Blacksburg, VA. Organizer

2020
- *Do you know what I'm looking at? Tracking eye movements during math games.* Eye-tracking technology Zoom outreach meetup sessions at the Virginia Tech Science Festival (Virtual), Blacksburg, VA. Organizer
- *Are you still watching? Using eye-tracking to understand learning from mobile media.* Institute for Creativity, Arts, and Technology (ICAT) Creativity + Innovation Day (Virtual), Blacksburg, VA. Organizer

2019
- *What are you looking at?* Eye-tracking station at the Virginia Tech Science Festival, Blacksburg, VA. Organizer

Professional Society Memberships

2023 -
- International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development
- Society for Applied Research in Memory and Cognition

2020 -
- Korean Association of Child Studies

2019 -
- Korean Society for Cognitive Enhancement and Intervention
- Korean Psychological Association, Developmental Psychology Division

2017 -
- Cognitive Science Society

2015 -
- Cognitive Development Society

2012 -
- International Congress of Infant Studies

2011 -
- Society for Research in Child Development